

the public sector, and jointly too.

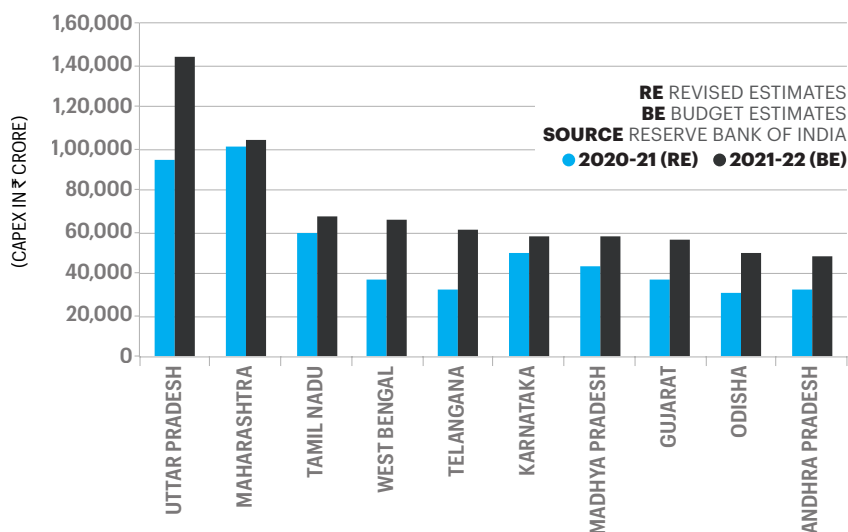
The thrust to attract tourists across all the states is a long-impending policy intervention that has the potential to not only develop the states as tourist destinations, but also help in making India a global tourist destination.

OTHER AREAS ARE also seeing innovation in policy-making. For example, the clean energy space is buzzing with policies and initiatives to reduce emissions and to achieve the net-zero target put forward by the PM. Be it solar, wind, or electric vehicles (EV) policy, almost all states are working to bring down emissions. And some are working day in and day out to bring out some policies that will help India achieve its own energy targets. For instance, Chhattisgarh's State Hydroelectric Project (Pump Storage based) Establishment Policy 2022 is aimed at encouraging investment for setting up of pump storage-based hydro power projects in the state. "States are scrambling and sprinting against time to come up with clean energy policies, be it EV policy, battery swapping policy and many more... the target is to reduce carbon emissions," says a clean energy expert.

Then, the Haryana government notified an Electric Vehicle Policy, under which 12 schemes have been made to encourage EVs. At the time of notification, Anand Mohan Sharan, then Additional Chief Secretary of the Industries and Commerce Department, had said that the aim of the EV policy was to promote the manufacturing of electric vehicles and their components in the state. With the formulation of this policy, research and development in the

CAPITAL MOVEMENTS

Top 10 states/UTs with the highest capital expenditure (capex)



"States are developing start-up ecosystems, reorienting their industrial policies, easing bottlenecks for investments... robust performance is reflected in the better business environment across the states"

SAKET DALMIA

PRESIDENT, PHD CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

field of EVs will be encouraged.

On the softer side, mental health is getting some well-deserved attention. Karnataka and Kerala were the first two states to have comprehensive policies in this sensitive area, with Meghalaya becoming the first state in the North-East to have a mental health policy. Officials say the policy seeks to address mental ill-health and ensure cultural security by engaging with the communities that the government serves.

The competition between states to create innovative policies that steer them towards greater economic and social development is a good one to have. As Dalmia of PHDCCI says: "I don't see any cut-throat competition between the states. They are only in healthy competition to create efficiencies in various socio-economic indicators for the welfare of the people." That is as it should be. **BT**

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